Boss Helicopter

Intro

The Boss Helicopter is relatively quick but maintains a very simple and predictable pattern. Players will be successful with good dodging and timing, but should try to remove the boss quickly as this one is particularly destructive to any buildings and sources of health and the spawners continue to create small enemies.

Type

Airbone Helicopter, Fast, Strafing.

Spawn

The boss will spawn at a location specified by the Level Designer / Artist. It will remain idle and wait for the player to approach it. While idle, it will taunt the player with audio cues and a particle effect to grab their attention.

When the player is within range, the boss goes from being idle to engaging with the player.

Behavior

Boss Helicopter maintains an altitude of about twice the height a normal Helicopter and roughly double their engagement distance. It has drift while airborne. Boss Helicopter will attempt to protect the spawner closest to the player. If the player maintains distance from the spawner, the Boss Helicopter will orbit the closest spawner and lob small groupings of 2-3 bombs at the player at regular intervals.
If the player gets close to a separate spawner, the boss will execute an attack arc to move over the player's head and place itself between the player and the new spawner.

Boss Helicopter attempts to keep itself between the player and the spawners

Boss Helicopter attempts to maintain a fixed distance from the player during windup up until the attack locks and the shield drops. The player could time a split-second throw and hit the boss before the attack cycle, but the timing has to be extremely tight.

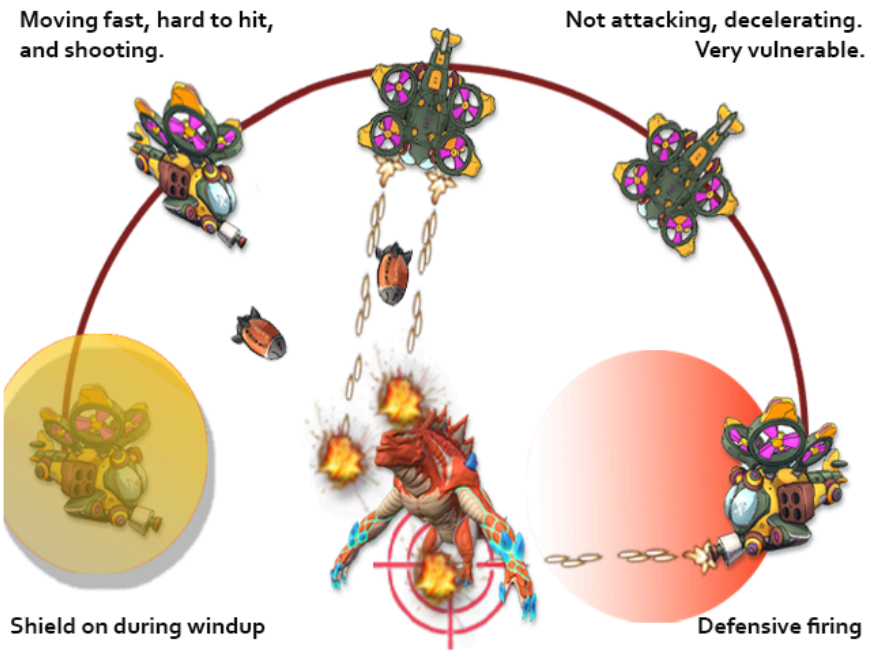
Attack

The boss attacks by flying over the player in an arc while rotating to face the player.

The boss rapidly accelerates into the arc before beginning to slow at the apex, descending with falling speed to a before coming to a vulnerable and telegraphed stop.

Boss Helicopter will fire a semi-accurate burst at the player and lob several bombs toward the player during the first half of the arc. Both of these attacks should be mostly dodge-able by a proactive player, and the bombs are grabbable just like the blimps.

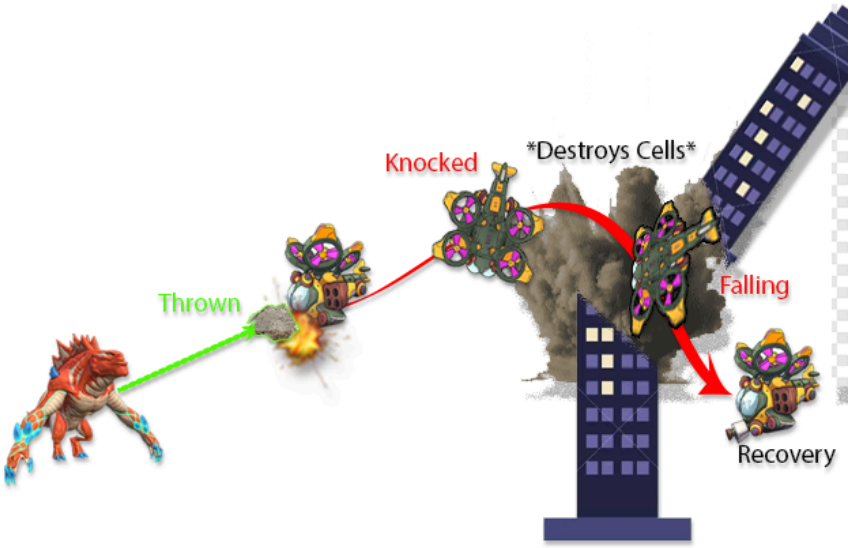
Boss Helicopter will deploy defensive firing if the player approaches it before it raises it's shield again.



The strafing run if the player were immobile.

Interactions

Boss Helicopter attempts to avoid obstacles except when hit. If struck, the Helicopter will lose control temporarily and fall, maintaining the impetus it had previously or being knocked back if stationary. It will destroy any building cells it collides with but prevent itself from striking the ground before raising its shield and returning to its ideal altitude.



The Helicopter falls when stricken, destroying building cells but recovering before hitting the ground.

After a strafing run or hit, the Helicopter will attempt to put itself between the player and spawner and prepare for a new attack run. It will fire on the player if the player gets too close during this time.

If the position of the player or the circumstances of the boss make it impossible to be between the player and a spawner, the Boss simply prefers to be somewhere “in the vicinity” of the spawner closest to the player (we can use a volume or specified radius or similar solution). The boss will attack the player even if it puts a spawner in jeopardy and will temporarily disable it’s own spawner if the player is clever enough to bait it into arcing over the spawner.

The player can bait the Helicopter to attack the spawner

Defence

The Helicopter is surrounded by an energy shield.

If the player touches the energy shield, the player lose 10 HP and will be electrocuted (😖 Status Effects) making the hand numb and useless so the player has to shake it to recover control of that hand quickly (else the effects goes away after 8 seconds on its own, shaking it reduces the time to just 2 seconds). Upon touch the boss will act according to it’s retreat sequence.

The shield is invulnerable against direct Special Power Damage.

The boss cannot be grabbed.

Player strategy

1. Wait for the Helicopter to come to a stop and drop it's shield, attempt to beat it to the punch.

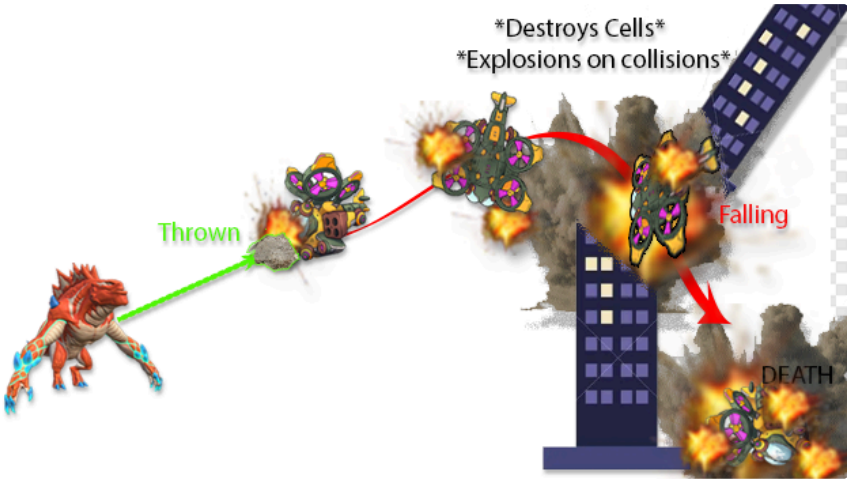
2. If that fails, the player dodges the incoming attack and attempts a second throw as Boss Helicopter descends from it's arc.
3. If the hit is successful, the player can use the Helicopter recovery time to attempt to temporarily disable the spawner to lighten their load.

Or
1. Get under the spawner, using it as a barrier, and inducing Boss Helicopter into striking the spawner.
2. Strike the boss Helicopter with an object as it ends its arc.
3. Attempt to get to the next-closest spawner and repeat the process to avoiding damage.

Staging

For each time the boss receives damage, the movement curve becomes steeper, it launches an additional bomb when attacking and the window of vulnerability at the end of the arc becomes shorter.

Once the player has successfully damaged the boss enough times, the boss caterwauls through the air (same behavior as a normal hit) while on fire and emitting smoke. Any collisions on the way down instantiate an explosion. When the boss hits the ground, it immolates with a dramatic final boom.



Boss Helicopter being dramatic.

As with all player interaction, positive hit on boss should give the player a clear feedback in the form of particle effects, sounds effects as well as animation (impulse from hit).